RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Backend Engineer (Python) | Principal Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer and engineering leader with 21 years of experience building backend services and APIs in Python, Go, and C++. Experienced in backend services, API platforms, distributed systems and relational databases, including PostgreSQL. Led development of high-throughput services and platform migrations, improving playback API availability to 99.95%. Experienced introducing RFCs, architecture reviews, and company-wide on-call guidelines.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH (video streaming), Munich *2019 – Aug 2026*

- Led the platform organisation of 5 teams, 45 engineers and 5 engineering managers, responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Drove migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services deployed on GKE, improving playback API availability from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Reduced cloud spend by 31% (€4.2M per year) through rightsizing, committed use discounts and an internal cost dashboard.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Grew the organisation from 18 to 45 engineers and conducted more than 200 interviews.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH *2015 – 2019*

- Served as technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Tornado, an internal web framework, Cassandra, and Redis.
- Designed an entitlement service handling 120,000 requests per second at peak, using Go and Cassandra.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart *2010 – 2015*

- Built backend fleet-telematics systems ingesting GPS data from 300,000 vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS, and RabbitMQ.
- Led the route-history product team of 6 developers.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe *2005 – 2010*

- Developed C++ and Python software for industrial data acquisition on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for 8 years.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent MSc), Computer Science | Rhine Valley University, 2005

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python (Django, Flask, FastAPI, Tornado, asyncio), Go, C++ (older)
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), AWS (EC2, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform
APIs, messaging, and observability: gRPC, Protobuf, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Other: Distributed systems design, architecture reviews, technical hiring, people management

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)

PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

- “Running Python at 100k rps” – EuroPython-style conference talk, 2018
- “Cost is a feature” – internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023